have been used by the Department since that year, has been forwarded to your address.

I am Sir, your obedient servant

W. Hunter

Acting Secretary.

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No. 213

Anson Burlingame, Esq. Department of State

&c. &c. &c. Washington, 28th Aug. 1867

Sir:

You are already acquainted with the tragic affair of the loss of the United States merchant vessel "Rover" off the Island of Formosa, and the destruction of her crew by the savages residing there.

From a report made upon that subject to the Secretary of the Navy by Rear Admiral Bell, I extract as follows:-

"I am satisfied that the barbarities of "those savages cannot be permanently "stopped until the Government at Peking "be induced, by the action of the American "and other Foreign Ministers at that Court, "to occupy all the villages and bays on "the East coast, and on the South, and "thus drive the aboriginals back to the



"interior of the Island. They are a cruel pest to all "mariners who may be so unfortunate as to be "thrown on their coast;- and there is no known "way of dealing with them as a community."

The President desires that you will confer with the representatives of the Western powers at Peking and in cooperation with them, if it shall be practicable, earnestly urge upon the Emperor's Government the policy suggested by Rear Admiral Bell. I shall look with much interest for your proceeding under this instruction.

I am, Sir, your obedient servant

William H. Seward